

Canadian Poutine

Yield: 3- 4 servings

Poutine is a dish of French fries and cheese curds topped with a brown gravy. It originated in the Canadian province of Quebec and emerged in the late 1950s in the Centre-du-Québec area. It has long been associated with Quebec cuisine. Today, it is often identified as a quintessential Canadian food and has been called "Canada's National Dish."

Oven Fries:

3 russet potatoes, scrubbed, washed well
3 tablespoons olive oil (45 ml)
½ teaspoons salt, (2.5 ml)
1 teaspoon pepper, divided (5 ml)

1 Tablespoon salt (for soaking in water)

Gravy and Cheese

4 tablespoons butter (60 ml)
2 Tbsp cup all-purpose flour (30 ml)
1 cups beef stock * (250 mL)
1 ½ teaspoons worcestershire sauce (7 ml)
2 tablespoons cornstarch (30 ml)
2 tablespoons cold water (30 ml)
1 cup cheese curd (250 ml)
¼ teaspoon salt (1 ml)

Preparation:

1. Preheat the oven to 450˚F (230˚C). Line 2 baking sheets with parchment paper.

2. On a cutting board, slice the potatoes into matchsticks by quartering lengthwise. Cut the quarters lengthwise into ¼-inch slices, then cut into ¼-inch (6 mm) matchsticks -*Alumette*. Practice your knife skills!

3. Place the potatoes in a large bowl. Drizzle with the olive oil and sprinkle with 1 teaspoon of salt and ½ teaspoon of pepper. Toss to coat.

4. Arrange the fries evenly in 2 rows on each baking sheet so they are not touching.

5. Bake for 25 minutes, flipping with a spatula halfway through, rotate pans in the oven for even cooking. Bake until golden brown.

6. While fries are in the oven, Make gravy: In a medium saucepan over medium heat, add the butter and flour. Whisk until the mixture is a golden brown. This thickened sauce is a *ROUX* . Add the beef stock, Worcestershire, remaining ½ teaspoon of salt and remaining ½ teaspoon of pepper. Bring to a boil, whisking continuously.

7. Add the water to the cornstarch in a small bowl and mix until dissolved. Add the cornstarch *slurry* to the gravy and stir until thickened. Remove from the heat and cover to keep gravy hot.

8. Transfer the baked fries to a large bowl, add the cheese curds, and pour the hot gravy over the top. Toss to coat.

9. Transfer to a dish and serve immediately. Serve with tong, Enjoy! Bon Appetite!

*NOTE: Beef stock can be re-constituted with 10 ml “Better than Bouillion” + 250 ml hot water

Source: https://tasty.co/recipe/classic-canadian-poutine